

3 April 2026

Application: Director of Engineering

Dear Hiring Team,

Proton's mission to make privacy the default on the internet resonates deeply with me. As an engineering leader who has spent over 15 years building secure, customer-facing products — and who chose Proton Mail as my primary email provider long before considering this role — I would be honoured to contribute to that mission as your next Director of Engineering.

At Ripple, I led an engineering organisation of 50 people across Geneva and London, delivering a cross-platform custody product spanning mobile, web and backend systems for institutional clients worldwide. I scaled the team from 15 to 50 engineers in 18 months while operating as a manager of managers — restructuring into autonomous squads, introducing DORA metrics, and driving DevSecOps practices that brought predictable, high-quality releases across all platforms. The product operated in a cryptographic context (HSM integration, key management, secure signing), giving me direct exposure to the kind of applied cryptography central to Proton's products. I partnered daily with C-level executives to align technical direction with business strategy.

My hands-on engineering roots run deep. As CTO of Bazzile, I personally built a cross-platform mobile application using Flutter and an Elixir backend — an entirely open-source stack — achieving 99.95% uptime. At FlowBank, I led the technology organisation of a digital consumer bank, delivering a customer-facing platform across web and mobile. Earlier in my career, I spent five years as a software engineer at Rolex building industrial systems, and served as Technical Lead at Swissquote — a consumer fintech platform serving millions of users. This progression from hands-on engineer to director gives me the technical credibility and product instinct that Proton values in its engineering leaders.

Beyond technical fit, I share Proton's DNA on openness and security. My own side project runs entirely on open-source technologies. My experience as an IT security auditor at Union Bancaire Privée — conducting IAM audits, GDPR compliance reviews, and reporting to top management on risk posture — has given me a privacy-first mindset that I carry into every architectural and organisational decision. I am based in Geneva and fully available for an on-site role.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience scaling engineering organisations, delivering cross-platform consumer products, and building secure systems can support Proton's next phase of growth.

Yours sincerely,

Thibault Fouache